

Marko Irisarri

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Employment

Lecturer in Economics (Assistant Professor), University of Manchester 2025-

Education

PhD in Economics (*Cum Laude*)

Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2020–2025

Advisors: Andrea Caggese and Dávid Krisztián Nagy

Thesis: Essays on Heterogeneous Firms in Macroeconomics:
Quantitative Frameworks and Policy Prescriptions

Master of Research in Economics

Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona, Spain 2019–2020

Master of Science in Economics

Barcelona School of Economics, Barcelona, Spain 2018–2019

Undergraduate Exchange Program

Warwick University, Coventry, UK 2017–2018

Undergraduate Degree in Economics

Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona, Spain 2014–2018

Research Interests

Primary Fields: Macroeconomics

Secondary Fields: Entrepreneurship, Quantitative Economics, Spatial Economics

Working Papers

• Entrepreneurship Across Space: Capital Misallocation and Place-Based Policies

Presented at: Manchester Macro Meeting, ECB's Young Economist Prize (finalist), Public University of Navarre (UPNA), Student Prize Session of the 14th European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association, The University of Edinburgh, The University of Manchester, UPF/CREi Macroeconomics and International Lunch seminars, ANEKO seminar at UPV/EHU

Are entrepreneurs and their capital optimally allocated across space, and should governments use place-based entrepreneurial policies? We develop a dynamic spatial quantitative framework with financial frictions, capital accumulation, occupational and location choices, and agglomeration forces. Using administrative and balance-sheet data from Spain, we show that returns to capital vary across space and that entrepreneurs in more productive urban areas face tighter capital constraints. Policy counterfactuals indicate that targeting a subset of the most productive urban areas yields larger national welfare and aggregate output gains than a spatially neutral policy, but at the cost of greater spatial concentration of economic activity.

• Entrepreneurship, Financial Frictions and Optimal Policy

The presence of financially constrained entrepreneurs generates an heterogeneity in returns which in turn leads to a non-trivial distinction between capital and wealth taxes. We study the effects of partial reforms

and optimal long-run taxation in a model that matches key U.S. economy moments on its pass-through sector and degree of inequality. Relative to the existing literature, we examine the implications of a wider set of tax instruments (including exemptions and inheritance taxes), inter-generational transmission of abilities and endogeneity of the occupational choice. We find that (i) a lower degree of inter-generational transmission of abilities weakens the welfare gains attainable through optimal policy (ii) allowing for a wider set of tax instruments, in particular an exemption on the wealth tax, leads to significant additional relative welfare gains (+30%) and shifts wealth taxation into positive territory (iii) the presence of the endogenous occupational choice dimension weakens the motive to substitute capital for wealth taxation, given the extensive margin misallocation that it entails.

Work in Progress

- **Floods and Adaptation Strategies: Evidence from Indian Manufacturing (joint with Alejandro Rábano and José Nicolás Rosas)**

Presented at: BSE Summer Forum 2026, 16th UEA Meeting, Bank of Spain

We study how manufacturing establishments in India adapt to flood risk. Combining establishment-level data with geo-coded flood records and regional economic indicators, we examine how production and investment decisions respond to flood events conditional on historical exposure. We find that investment is more resilient in high-risk areas, consistent with forward-looking adaptation. To rationalize these findings, we propose a firm dynamics model featuring flood risk and private insurance to floods through a flood preventing capital. To overcome the curse of dimensionality in this dynamic spatial model with aggregate uncertainty, we resort to Deep Learning techniques. We employ the model to quantify the aggregate economic impact of floods and evaluate the effectiveness of adaptation in mitigating climate-induced damages, and find that the proposed mechanism can replicate the patterns in the data

- **Firm Dynamics, Agglomeration Forces and Green Innovation (joint with Andrea Caggese)**

Teaching Experience

Graduate Courses at The University of Manchester

Lecturer in Macroeconomics	2025-
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Graduate Courses at Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Teaching Assistant for Advanced Techniques in Macroeconomics I	2022
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Undergraduate Courses at Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Teaching Assistant for Data Analysis	2022-2023
Teaching Assistant for Data Analysis and Introduction to Statistics	2021-2022
Teaching Assistant for Data Analysis and Introduction to Game Theory	2020-2021
Teaching Assistant for Information Economics and Introduction to Game Theory	2019-2020

Research Experience

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Research Assistant for Professor Andrea Caggese	2021
Research Assistant for Professor Andrea Caggese	2020

Seminar Presentations

BSE Summer Forum	2026
16th Meeting of The Urban Economics Association,	2026
Public University of Navarre (UPNA/NUP),	2025

14th Meeting of The Urban Economics Association, Student Prize Session	2025
ANEKO Seminar UPV/EHU	2025
CREi International Lunch	2023-2024
CREi Macro Lunch	2020-2023

Scholarships and Awards

ECB Young Economist Prize, finalist,	2025
Student Prize 14th Meeting Urban Economics Association, finalist,	2025
Master's Thesis distinction, Barcelona School of Economics	2019

Refereeing

Regional Science and Urban Economics

Departmental Service

Macroeconomics Seminar Series Organizer (University of Manchester)	2026
Coordinator for Bojos per l'Economia (CREi)	2022-2023

Languages and Computer Skills

Languages: English (C2), Basque (C1), Catalan (C1), Spanish (Native)

Programming: C++, CUDA/C++, Matlab, Python, Stata, $\LaTeX$, Git, Markdown